

Off the Shelf



BEACH HEAD 2002

Being Private Ryan

Stuck as the lone gunman taking a S dying stance on a beach under assault? That's what you get for getting frisky with the General's daughter! *BEACH HEAD 2002* calls for one good man, you, to defend a solitary strip of beach armed with a 30 mm gun, your antitank gun, some missiles and for those ammo-starved days, a handgun. The available weapons vary between levels, thus avoiding tedium that would have otherwise have crept in. The game also features friendly bombers that drop crates of ammunition and armour. The catch being that you need to shoot the boxes out of the air in order to replenish the same attributes. Every few missions, the game plunges you into a night time



PRETTY MEN ALL IN A ROW: You shoot one down, he falls to the ground, 99 more to go

mission. A workday is never dull with companies of soldiers, tanks, attack helicopters, bombers, fighter planes and

troop carrying vehicles making regular pit stops at your local haunt. The number, frequency and the pattern of visitations, of course, change as you climb the ladder of levels. The game has acceptable graphics, considering its system requirements. The soldiers are sprites with minimum frames of animation, making them look jittery. There are also problems with collision detection within the game: a plane will sometimes fly right through a hill without a scratch. *BEACH HEAD 2002* calls for some insane reflexes, and shows both the addictive and the one-more-level syndrome that is the hallmark of good games. With an affordable price tag, this may be just the dose of fun that you were looking for.

Developer: Digital Fusion ■ **Distributor:** Milestone Interactive Software Ltd ■ **Phone:** 022-28381614 ■ **Web site:** www.fusiongames.com
Price: Rs 499 ■ **System requirements:** Pentium 350 MHz processor or equivalent, 64 MB RAM, 4 MB AGP/PCI video card ■ **Rating:** ★★★★★



Tom and Jerry in Fists of Furry

A cat and mouse game, no kidding!

Tom and Jerry in Fists of Furry is a 3D fighting game starring characters from the cartoon. The game is pretty a much direct PC conversion of the same-named hit Nintendo N64 game. It successfully brings along the same fun and zest that the series introduced.

The game features one-on-one fighting in venues modelled after classic episodes of the cartoon series such as an alley, a kitchen, a farm, etc. There are 10



PUNCH DRUNK: Jerry experiences one of the finer things in life, courtesy Tom, of course!

kitchen sink!

Combat essentially involves punching, kicking, ducking, catching and throwing household items. You can also kick an item across the floor, and envi-

levels in all, some of which you must unlock by making your way through the single player game. Characters like Tom, Jerry, Tyke, Spike and Duckling will punch, kick and assail each other with weapons that include shovels, bombs, red-hot poker, tennis rackets, furniture, an assortment of fruits and a

ronmental hazards such as fire and falling pots can put the hurt on you. Power-ups take the form of yellow question marks and offer boosts such as invisibility and energy sapping, contagious measles. The game is quite challenging and for the most part, the challenge is well-balanced. Bouts can get frustrating, but the cartoon elements that decorate the game keep you going long enough to enjoy the ride. *Fists of Furry* is an experience that is at times enjoyable, at times frustrating, but always interesting. It's the kind of game that you occasionally get into for 15-minute sessions of action at a time. It is not likely to involve you to an extent where you would find yourself whiling away the hours until you've beaten the last level.

Developer: NewKidCo ■ **Distributor:** Milestone Interactive Software Ltd ■ **Phone:** 022-28381614 ■ **Web site:** www.fusiongames.com ■ **Price:** Rs 499
System requirements: Pentium 233 MHz processor or equivalent, 64 MB RAM, 16 MB DirectX 8 compatible video card ■ **Rating:** ★★★★★